

James Yiming Zhu

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

My research interests focus on *social computing*, *data science*, and *natural language processing*. Standing at the intersection of the big data and AI era, I aim to investigate how emerging generative AI (GenAI) technologies are reshaping the Internet ecosystem and online social networks. Additionally, I am passionate about addressing practical challenges related to GenAI misuse, helping platforms to better moderate and mitigate harmful AI applications.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

- **Hong Kong University of Science and Technology (Guangzhou) (HKUST (GZ))** April 2025 - October 2026
Guangzhou, Guangdong, China
Research Assistant (Part time)
 - Advised by [Prof. Pan Hui](#).
- **Hong Kong University of Science and Technology (Guangzhou) (HKUST (GZ))** December 2025 - March 2026
Guangzhou, Guangdong, China
Research Assistant (Part time)
 - Co-work with [Dr. Ehsan-UI Haq](#); Advised by [Prof. Gareth Tyson](#).
- **University of Science and Technology of China (USTC)** July 2020 - August 2021
Hefei, Anhui, China
Research Assistant
 - Advised by [Prof. Cheng Li](#).
 - Research project published at APSys 2021: “Lessons learned from migrating complex stateful applications onto serverless platforms”.
- **Hong Kong University of Science and Technology (HKUST)** July 2019 - September 2019
Hong Kong, China
Research Intern
 - Supervised by [Prof. Lik-Hang Lee](#) and [Prof. Pan Hui](#).
 - Research project published at PerCom 2020: “One-thumb text acquisition on force-assisted miniature interfaces for mobile headsets”.

EDUCATION

- **Hong Kong University of Science and Technology (HKUST)** September 2021 - Present
Hong Kong, China
Doctor of Philosophy in IIP (AI)
- **University of Science and Technology of China (USTC)** September 2016 - June 2020
Hefei, Anhui
Bachelor in Computer Science and Technology

PUBLICATIONS (* DENOTES EQUALLY CONTRIBUTION)

- [1] Yupeng He*, **Yiming Zhu***, Pan Hui, Gareth Tyson. **Beyond Human-Made Beats: Measuring and Detecting AI-Generated Music on SoundCloud**. [ACM MM 2026].
- [2] Yawei Zhao, **Yiming Zhu**, Hao Li, Yuqi Liang, Ao Yu, Anca-Simona Horvath, Pan Hui. **Toward Site-Aware MR Art Exhibitions: A SLAM-Based Deployment Pipeline for Spatial Coherence and Exhibition Experience**. [ACM MM 2026].
- [3] **Yiming Zhu**, Yupeng He, Ehsan-UI Haq, Gareth Tyson, Pan Hui. **Characterizing GenAI-driven Social Network: The Chirper.ai Case**. [ACM CSCW 2026].
- [4] **Yiming Zhu**, Gareth Tyson, Yupeng He, Pan Hui. **The Rise of Synthetic Grassroots: Characterizing AI-Generated Political Discourse on Reddit**. [In Submission].
- [5] **Yiming Zhu**, Gareth Tyson, Pan Hui. **The Invisible Hand: Exploring Generative AI’s Impact on Online Freelancer Markets**. [In Submission].
- [6] **Yiming Zhu**, Peixian Zhang, Ehsan-UI Haq, Pan Hui, and Gareth Tyson. **Exploring the Capability of ChatGPT to Reproduce Human Labels for Social Computing Tasks**. [ASONAM 2024].
- [7] Yiluo Wei*, **Yiming Zhu***, Pan Hui, Gareth Tyson. **Exploring the Use of Abusive Generative AI Models on Civitai**. [ACM MM 2024].
- [8] **Yiming Zhu**, Zhizhuo Yin, Gareth Tyson, Ehsan-UI Haq, Lik-Hang Lee, Pan Hui. **APT-Pipe: A Prompt-Tuning Tool for Social Data Annotation using ChatGPT**. [ACM WWW 2024].
- [9] Ehsan-UI Haq, **Yiming Zhu**, Pan Hui, Gareth Tyson. **History in making: Political campaigns in the era of artificial intelligence-generated content**. [ACM WWW Companion 2024].

- [10] **Yiming Zhu**, Ehsan-Ul Haq, Gareth Tyson, Lik-Hang Lee, Yuyang Wang, Pan Hui. **A Study of Partisan News Sharing in the Russian invasion of Ukraine**. [ICWSM 2024].
- [11] Ehsan-Ul Haq, **Yiming Zhu**, Zijun Lin, Haodi Weng, Gareth Tyson, Lik-Hang Lee, Reza Hadi Mogavi, Tristan Braud, Pan Hui. **Understanding Characteristics of Catalyst Users in the WallStreetBets Community**. [ASONAM 2023].
- [12] Peixian Zhang, Ehsan Ul Haq, **Yiming Zhu**, Pan Hui, Gareth Tyson. **Echo Chambers within the Russo-Ukrainian War: The Role of Bipartisan Users**. [ASONAM 2023].
- [13] Zewen Jin, **Yiming Zhu**, Jiaan Zhu, Dongbo Yu, Cheng Li, Ruichuan Chen, Istemi Ekin Akkus, Yinlong Xu. **Lessons Learned from Migrating Complex Stateful Applications onto Serverless Platforms**. [ACM APSys 2021].
- [14] Lik Hang Lee, **Yiming Zhu**, Yui-Pan Yau, Pan Hui, Susanna Pirttikangas. **Press-n-paste: Copy-and-paste Operations with Pressure-sensitive Caret Navigation for Miniaturized Surface in Mobile Augmented Reality**. PACMHCI EICS 2021.
- [15] Lik Hang Lee, **Yiming Zhu**, YAU Yui-Pan, Tristan Braud, SU Xiang, Pan Hui. **One-thumb text acquisition on force-assisted miniature interfaces for mobile headsets**. [IEEE PerCom 2020].

AWARDS & HONORS

- **Best Reviewer of ACM Transactions on Social Computing (TSC)** 2026

TEACHING AND ADVISING EXPERIENCE

- **Hong Kong University of Science and Technology Guangzhou (HKUST (GZ))** February 2025 - May 2025
Guest Lecturer of Social Media for Creatives (CMAA 5022) Guangzhou, China
- **Hong Kong University of Science and Technology Guangzhou (HKUST (GZ))** September 2023 - December 2023
Teaching Assistant of Metaverse Cross-disciplinary Design Thinking (EMIA 6500C) Guangzhou, China
- **Hong Kong University of Science and Technology Guangzhou (HKUST (GZ))** February 2023 - May 2023
Teaching Assistant of Social Media for Creatives (CMAA 5022) Guangzhou, China

INVITED TALK

- **Investigating the Limitations and Risks in Online Agent-driven Social Networks** July 7th 2026
International Conference on Large Language Models and Data Science Applications in the Humanities and Social Sciences

SERVICE AND LEADERSHIP

- **PC Member of the ACM Web Conference (WWW) – Web4good Track** 2025
- **Reviewer of ACM Transactions on Social Computing (TSC)** 2025, 2026
- **Reviewer of International AAAI Conference on Web and Social Media (ICWSM)** 2023-2026
- **Reviewer of PACM for Conference on Computer Supported Cooperative Work (CSCW)** 2023, 2024
- **Reviewer of Proceedings of the ACM Web Conference (WWW)** 2023-2025

SKILLS

- **Programming Language:** Python.
- **Skills for Language Model:** Prompt tuning, model fine-tuning.
- **Web Technologies:** Web crawler development.
- **Data Science & Machine Learning:** Statistic comparative analysis, user modeling, large data mining, natural language processing.